

Lyme Antibodies, Modified 2-Tier Testing Profile, Serum/Plasma

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Chemiluminescent Immunoassay (CLIA)

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

1 - 2 days

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Use

This panel utilizes FDA-cleared assays following the modified 2-tier testing (MTTT) algorithm to aid in the diagnosis of Lyme disease in individuals with clinical signs and symptoms consistent with Lyme disease. Lyme disease should be considered based on the presence of typical signs and symptoms of infection in patients with a history of possible exposure to infected ticks.

Special Instructions

Specimens are tested using an immunoassay measuring total antibodies to specific borrelial proteins; if reactive, the specimens reflex to separate IgG and IgM immunoassays targeting additional *Borrelia burgdorferi* proteins.

Limitations

Screening of the general population should not be performed. The positive predictive value depends on the likelihood of Lyme disease being present. Testing should only be performed on patients with clinical symptoms of Lyme disease or when exposure is suspected.

In general, IgM tests should be disregarded if the patient's symptoms have lasted more than 30 days. If the patient has been sick longer than 30 days, only IgG results should be interpreted.

Potential assay interference due to circulating antibodies in patients with Human Ehrlichiosis (HE) and Tick Borne Relapsing Fever (TBRF), Babesiosis, Parvovirus, and EBV infections has been found. Interpret results from these patients with caution.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum **or** plasma

Volume

2.0 mL

Minimum Volume

0.75 mL (**Note:** This volume does **not** allow for repeat testing.)

Container

Gel-barrier tube, serum transfer tube, **or** EDTA plasma, lithium heparin plasma, or plasma transfer tubes

Collection Instructions

If tube other than a gel-barrier is used, transfer separated serum or plasma to a labeled plastic transport tube. Do **not** freeze gel-barrier tube (pour off serum first).

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	14 days
Refrigerated	14 days
Frozen	14 days
Freeze/thaw cycles	Stable x3

Reference Range

Negative

Storage Instructions

Room temperature

Causes for Rejection

Gross hemolysis; gross lipemia; samples containing particulate matter or exhibiting obvious microbial contamination

References

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